

YAKU DESIGN SYSTEM

The foundations and components behind ordering at the table in Yaku, a Peruvian—Mexican restaurant in Hamburg: the guest app and the kitchen display.

Every value comes from the real code.

Two modes share one accent: the yellow of ají.

Basics
Principles

Foundations
Colour

Foundations
Typography

Foundations
Spacing and radii

Foundations
Depth

Foundations
Grid

Foundations
Icons

Components
Simple components

Components
Complex components

Process
Next steps

Typefaces Td Neumann · Jost **Modes** dark and light **Accent** ají yellow **Source of truth** `src/estilos.css` **Platform** mobile first, 520 px column · kitchen tablet

Token names in Spanish, as in the code

Basics

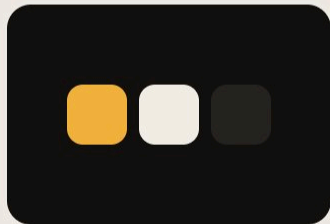
PRINCIPLES

The system is built from small to large.

A change to one token reaches every piece that uses it, in both modes at once.

From token to page

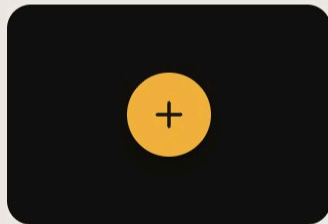
Each level is made only of pieces from the level before.
Under each one, a real example from Yaku.



Tokens

Colours,
type, measurements.

--aji · --lado



Atoms

The smallest piece
that means something.

.mas-foto



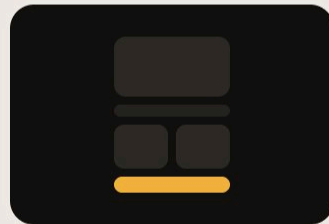
Molecules

A few atoms together.
.contador



Organisms

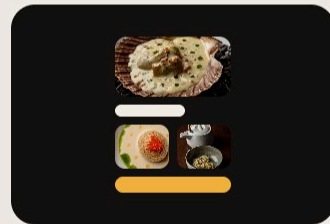
Complete blocks of a screen.
.tarjeta



Templates

The order of the blocks,
without data.

Menu



Pages

The template
with real dishes.

/?mesa=...

House rules

Decisions already made, valid for any new screen.

The food leads

Large photos, few words. The dark mode exists so the dishes glow.

Two modes, one accent

Warm black or the canvas texture of Yaku’s website. Ají yellow works on both.

Menu typography

Dish names in Td Neumann capitals, like the printed menu. Everything else in Jost.

Yellow = add

Ají marks the next step: add a dish, place the order, the step you are in.

The kitchen reads from afar

Always dark, high contrast, 18 px and up. Built for busy hands and a tablet on the wall.

Two languages

German and English everywhere. The guest switches with one tap.

Foundations

COLOUR

Warm neutrals for each mode and one shared accent.

The black number on each colour is its contrast with the background of its mode (WCAG).

Base colours

Light mode sits on the canvas texture.

Dark mode is a warm black, with no green or blue in it.

LIGHT

Canvas
#f4efe6

15.6

Ink
#1a1714

5.1

Stone
#6b645b

1.3

Line
#ddd5c8

5.2

Ají text
#8a5a00

5.7

Vegan
#1c6b3a

5.1

Veggie
#5c6b1c

DARK

Warm black
#121110

Surface
#1c1a18

Surface 2
#262320

16.3

Cream
#f2eee6

7.4

Ash
#a8a198

10.9

Vegan
#8fd4a5

11.9

Veggie
#c9d48f

SHARED

10.1

Ají
#f2b33d

3.5 · 4.8

Error
#d9534f

Note marker
#ffe7b3

Version 2.6

4 / 33

Variables with meaning

The code never writes a colour by hand.
Each variable has a light and a dark value, and the screen switches between them.

Variable	Light	Dark	Used for	Contrast light · dark
--fondo	 #f4efe6	 #121110	Page background (light: with the canvas texture)	— · —
--superficie	 #fffdf9	 #1c1a18	Buttons, lines, fields (light: 78% over the texture)	— · —
--superficie-2	 #eae3d7	 #262320	Counter, chip groups, empty ring	— · —
--linea	 #ddd5c8	 #2e2b27	Thin borders and dividers	decor. · decor.
--texto	 #1a1714	 #f2eee6	All text and headings	15.6 · 16.3
--suave	 #6b645b	 #a8a198	Prices, descriptions, help	5.1 · 7.4
--invertido	 #1a1714	 #f2eee6	Order bar, active choice, done step	15.6 · 16.3
--aji	 #f2b33d	 #f2b33d	Main button, plus, progress, focus	— · 10.1
--sobre-aji	 #1a1714	 #1a1714	Text on ají	9.6 · 9.6
--aji-texto	 #8a5a00	 #f2b33d	Eyebrows: ají as small text	5.2 · 10.1
--vegan	 #1c6b3a	 #8fd4a5	Vegan tag and filter	5.7 · 10.9
--veggie	 #5c6b1c	 #c9d48f	Veggie tag	5.1 · 11.9
--velo-foto	rgb(18 17 16 / .7)	same	Veil under text on photos	— · —

Checked pairs

Text on background, exactly as it appears on screen.
One pair still fails and is listed under next steps.

Ceviches

AA ✓15.6

13,00 €

AA ✓5.1

CHEF’S PICK

AA ✓5.2

Add

AA ✓9.6

Ceviches

AA ✓16.3

13,00 €

AA ✓7.4

CHEF’S PICK

AA ✓10.1

Error

Fails AA3.5

Foundations

TYPOGRAPHY

Two voices.

Td Neumann speaks like the menu, always in capitals.

Jost does the work: descriptions, prices, buttons.

AA

Td Neumann

Display only. Capitals, letter spacing 0.02em, line height 1. Dish names, screen titles, the kitchen's table numbers.

CEVICHE CHELERO · TOCINO DE CIELO

Aa

Jost

Text and interface. Weights 400 · 500 · 600 · 700. Self-hosted with fontsource.

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789 · 13,00 € · Table 99

Display scale

Every size of Td Neumann in the guest app and the kitchen.

Status number	12	58 px Live status ring
Kitchen sign-in	KÜCHE	48 px Kitchen
Welcome	WHAT WOULD YOU LIKE?	40 px First screen
Dish title	TIRADITO CHALACO	38 px Dish sheet
Order title	YOUR ORDER	36 px Order
Status title	IN THE KITCHEN.	32 px Live status
Ticket table	TISCH 4	30 px Kitchen ticket
Featured dish	JACOB PITUCO	28 px Menu
Kitchen column	IN ZUBEREITUNG	26 px Kitchen
Menu section	CEVICHES	22 px Menu

Text scale

Jost sizes, from the kitchen’s ticket lines down to the eyebrow above a dish.

Ticket line	2x Ceviche Chelero	18 px · 500
Price on the sheet, total	16,00 €	18 px · 500
Body, buttons, fields	Place order	16 px · 600
Tabs	Yaku Abierto	15 px · 400
Dish name on a card	MAR NIKKEI	14 px · 600
Descriptions on photos, filters	Scallop with mango hollandaise sauce	13 px · 400
Chips, steps, notes	Table 99	12 px · 500
Eyebrow, tags	CHEF’S PICK	11 px · 600

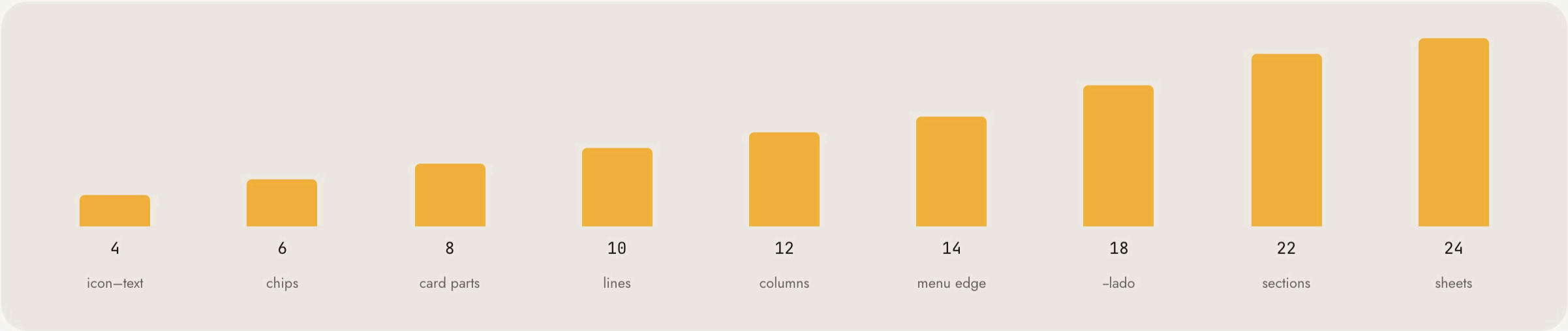
Foundations

SPACING AND RADII

Soft corners everywhere: pills for actions, round photos for dishes.
The screen edge keeps a margin of 18 px.

Spacing in use

The values that repeat most in the code. --lado = 18 px is the screen side margin.



Corner radii

Two are tokens (`--radio`, `--radio-l`).
The others are written in each piece.



14
Thumbnails, kitchen button



16 · --radio
Note field



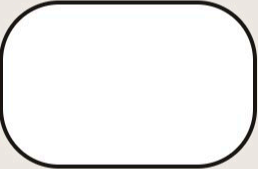
18
Kitchen ticket



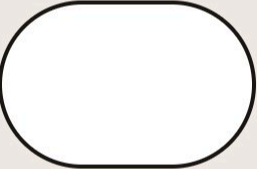
20
Dish photo, order line



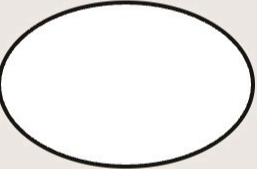
26 · --radio-l
Featured dish



30
Dish sheet top



pill
Buttons, chips, bar

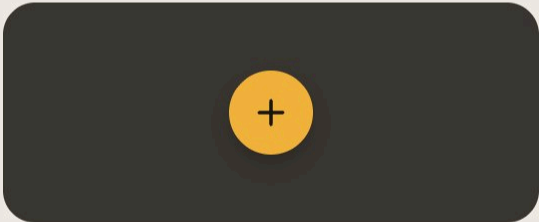


circle
Plus, counter, ring

Foundations

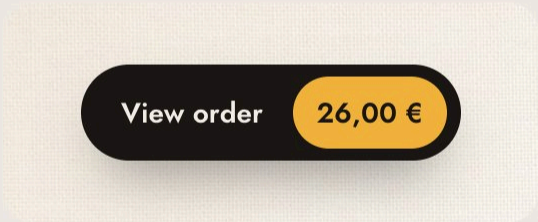
DEPTH

Few shadows, used only on what floats over food or over the page.



Plus on a photo

0 6px 16px -6px / .5



Order bar

0 14px 30px -12px / .55



Glass button

black .72 + blur 8px



New order ring

0 0 0 4px aji, pulses twice

Keyboard focus

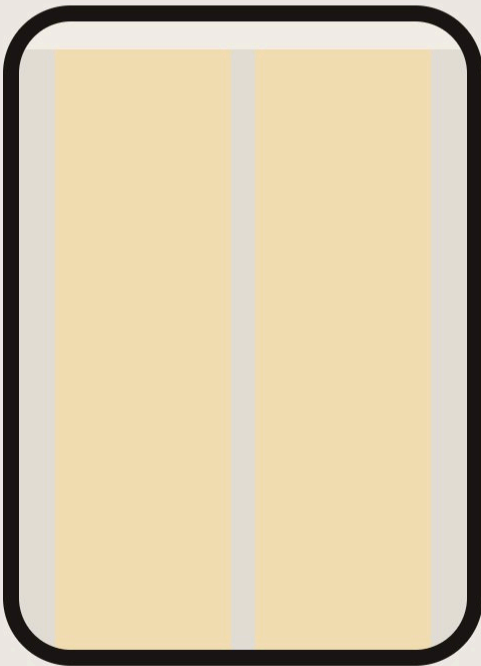
A 3 px ají ring, 2 px away.
Visible on the canvas and on warm black.



Foundations

GRID

One centred column, 520 px at most, for the guest.
Three columns for the kitchen: received, cooking, served.



Side margin --lado · 18 px

Max width 520 px

Dish grid 2 columns · 18 / 12 px

Featured dish 330 px high

Dish photo 58% of the screen

Order bar 60 px · floats 14 px up

Kitchen 3 columns · 18 px · 1 below 900 px

Foundations

ICONS

A handful of line icons, drawn in SVG on a 24 px grid.
Drawn, not typed: a plus as a letter never sits in the middle of its circle.



Add · more



Less



Back



Light mode



Dark mode

Components

SIMPLE COMPONENTS

The small pieces repeated on every screen.
Each one is shown in both modes.



Place order

Buttons

Main, secondary,
round, plus



— 1 +

Counter

Less and more



DE EN

Chips

Table, language



Vegan

Filters and tags

Vegan, veggie



Ceviches

Tabs

Menu sections



no coriander

Note field

For the kitchen

Simple component

BUTTONS

Always pills or circles.
The yellow one is the next step.
There is only one per screen.

LIGHT

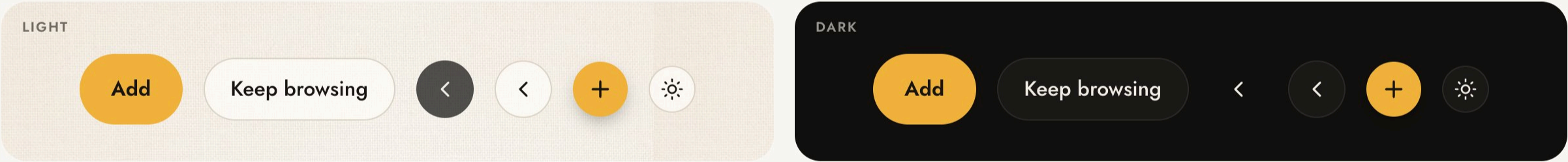
Place order

DARK

Place order

Types

Main in ají, secondary with a thin line, round glass buttons over photos, the plus on every dish and the theme switch.



Measurements

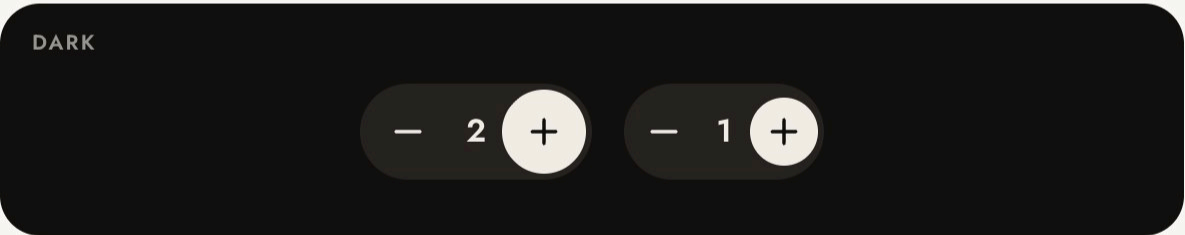
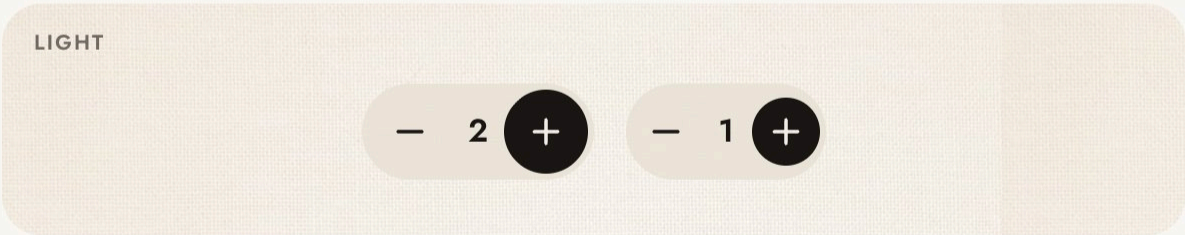
Every target is 42 px or more, so a guest can tap without looking twice.

Main	Secondary	Round	Plus
Height54	Height48	Size44	Size42
Padding0 24	Padding0 20	Fillblack .72	Icon20 · stroke 2.2
TypeJost 16 / 600	TypeJost 16 / 500	Blur8	Fill-aji
Fill-aji	Border1 · -linea	Over photosyes	Shadowyes
Text-sobre-aji			

Simple component

COUNTER

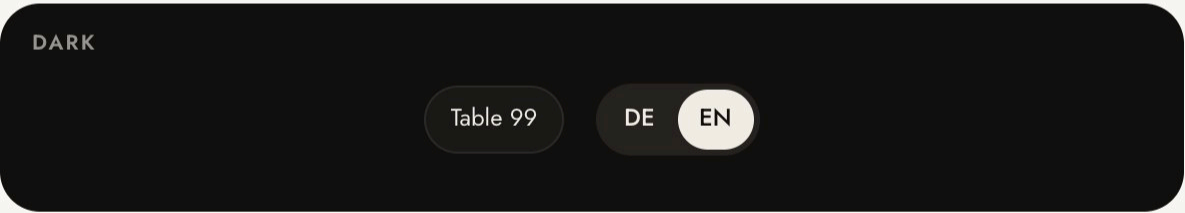
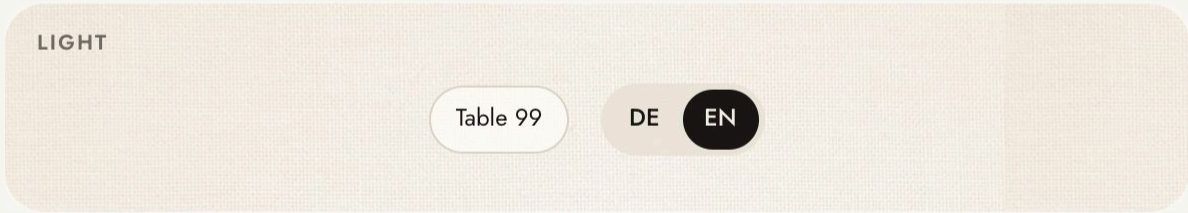
How many of a dish.
The plus is filled, because adding is the common action.
Up to 20.



Simple component

CHIPS

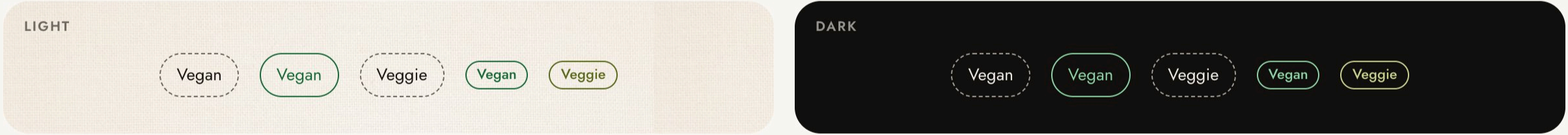
Small facts and small choices: which table you are at, which language you read.



Simple component

FILTERS AND TAGS

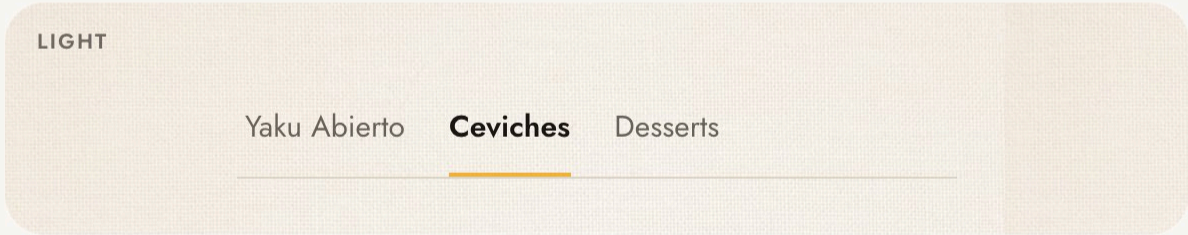
A filter has a dashed line until you choose it.
Tags have the same colour, but you can't tap them.



Simple component

TABS

The menu's sections.
They stick to the top while you scroll, and the active one gets an ají line.



Simple component

NOTE FIELD

One field in the whole app: a note for the kitchen, up to 200 characters.
Text at 16 px, so the iPhone does not zoom in.

LIGHT

Note for the kitchen

e.g. no coriander

Note for the kitchen

No coriander, please

DARK

Note for the kitchen

e.g. no coriander

Note for the kitchen

No coriander, please

Components

COMPLEX COMPONENTS

Large pieces made of the simple ones, from the first look at the menu to the ticket in the kitchen.



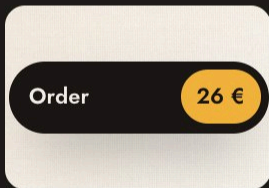
Featured dish

Chef's pick



Dish card

Photo, name, price



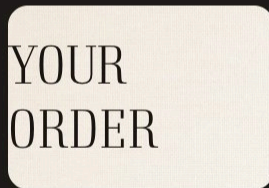
Order bar

Always in reach



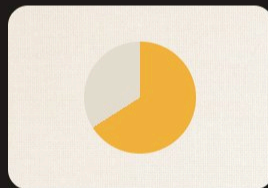
Dish sheet

Immersive



Order lines

Review before sending



Live status

Ring and steps



Kitchen ticket

Tablet display

Complex component

FEATURED DISH

The first thing on the menu.

A large photo with a dark veil at the bottom, so the text reads the same in both modes.



Complex component

DISH CARD

Two to a row.

A square photo with soft corners, the name in capitals, the price and the tags.
Sold out turns grey.



Complex component

ORDER BAR

It appears with the first dish and floats above the menu.
It inverts the mode, so it never blends into the page.



Complex component

DISH SHEET

The photo takes more than half the screen.
The sheet slides over it with a 30 px radius and holds everything you need to decide.

LIGHT



CEVICHES

16,00 €

TIRADITO
CHALACO

Thinly sliced salmon with olive mayonnaise,
nori seaweed and avocado cream.

—

1

+

Add

DARK



CEVICHES

16,00 €

TIRADITO
CHALACO

Thinly sliced salmon with olive mayonnaise,
nori seaweed and avocado cream.

—

1

+

Add

Complex component

ORDER LINES

One line per dish, with its note for the kitchen in italics.
You pay at the table as usual.

LIGHT



CEVICHE CHELERO

"No coriander"

16,00 €

—

1

+



TOCINO DE CIELO

10,00 €

—

1

+

DARK



CEVICHE CHELERO

"No coriander"

16,00 €

—

1

+



TOCINO DE CIELO

10,00 €

—

1

+

Complex component

LIVE STATUS

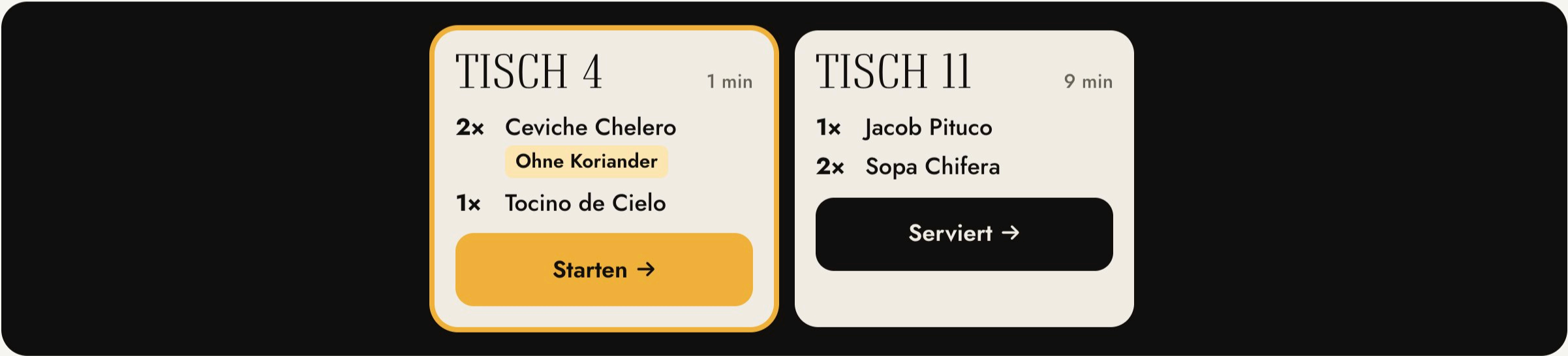
After ordering, the guest sees the kitchen at work.
The ring fills in aji and counts the minutes.
Three steps: received, cooking, served.



Complex component

KITCHEN TICKET

The kitchen display is always dark and speaks German, the language of the team.
Tickets are cream, with the table number in Td Neumann and notes on a yellow marker.
A new order pulses twice.



Process

NEXT STEPS

What this version documents as it is, and what the next one should tidy up.

DONE

A centred plus

The plus and minus are drawn in SVG, not typed. They sit exactly in the middle of their circles.

DONE

Two modes from one set

Every colour is a variable with a light and a dark value. The guest's phone decides, and the sun and moon button overrides it.

NEXT

A readable error

The error red #d9534f reaches only 3.5 on the light canvas. It needs a darker light value.

NEXT

Scales as tokens

Type sizes, spacing and most radii are still written in each piece. They should become short token scales, as in Otra Mesa.